Graph-based Test Coverage (A&O Ch. 1, 2.1 – 2.3)

(2nd Ed: 2,3,5,7.1 – 7.3)

Course Software Testing & Verification

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Plan

- The concept of “test coverage”
- Graph-based coverage
- Constructing CFG from code

Note: graph-based coverage is probably the most well known concept of coverage after line coverage. It is a good foundation towards more advanced concept of coverage.

Are we good now?

- So now you know how to write tests (at least, unit tests).
- Next, you came up with a bunch of tests.
- Question: are these tests “enough” ?

Test Coverage

Doing more tests improves the completeness of our testing, but at some point we have to stop (e.g. we run out of money). Let's try to provide a measure:

Test coverage: a *measure* to compare the relative completeness of our testing (e.g. to say that a "test set" T_1 is relatively more complete than another set T_2).

As a measure, it is *quantitative*.

Simple example: line coverage

```
foo(x,y) {
   while (x>y)
       x=x-y ;
    if (x<y)
       return -1
    else
       return x }
```

- A *test-case*: another name for a "test".
- A *test-set* (Def 1.18/2nd Ed 3.20): is just a set of test-cases.
- We can for example require that the test set of foo "covers" every line in the code of foo. (a test set **covers** a line, if there is one test case whose execution visits the line)

Simple example: line coverage

```
foo(x,y) {
   while (x>y)
       x=x-y ;
    if (x<y)
       return -1
    else
       return x }
```

As a quantitative measure we can talk about:

- Which lines are covered
- How many lines are covered
- Percentage of the lines covered

Is it a good measure?

```
foo(x,y) { while (x>y)  x=x-y ; if (x<y) return -1 else return x }
```

A single test will give full line coverage, but this obviously misses testing some logic of foo().

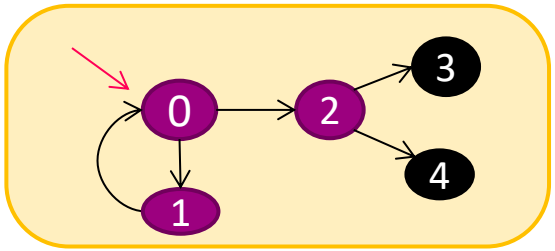
```
foo(x,y) {
   while (x>y)
       x=x-y ;
    if (x<y)
       return -1
    else
       return x }
```

A less trivial example: a test set with full line coverage may miss the scenario where the loop is immediately skipped.

Graph-based test coverage

foo(x,y) { **while** (x>y) x=x-y ; **if** (x<y) return -1 **else** return x }

0 1 2 3 4



- Abstractly, a program is a set of nodes and edges connecting the nodes. An execution flows through the edges, to form a path through the program.
- This can be captured by a so called *Control Flow Graph* (CFG, Legard 1970), such as the one above.
- AO gives you a set of graph-based coverage concepts; most are stronger than line coverage.

Graph terminology

- (Sec 2.1/2nd Ed 7.1) A <u>*graph*</u> is described by (N,N_0,N_f,E). E is a subset of $N \times N$.
  - directed, for now: no labels, no multi-edges.

- A <u>*path*</u> p is a sequence of nodes $[n_0, n_1, \ldots, n_k]$
  - non-empty
  - each consecutive pair is an edge in E

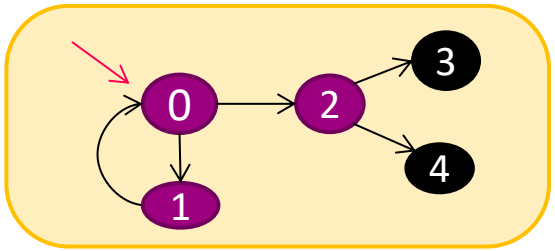
- <u>*length*</u> of p = #edges in p = natural length of $p - 1$

CFG and Test Path

```
foo(x,y) { while (x>y)   x=x-y ;  if (x<y) return -1 else return x }
```

0 1 2 3 4

CFG of foo:



- Control Flow Graph (CFG) is a graph representing a program in terms of how it transitions from one statement to another. We furthermore assume:
  - There is only one initial node.
  - Any execution ends in a terminal node (this implies that if a program can terminates by throwing an exception, a terminal node should be added to model this).
- A *test-path* (Def. 2.31) is a path in the CFG representing the execution of a test case. It should therefore starts at the CFG's initial node, and ends in a terminal node of the CFG.

More terminology

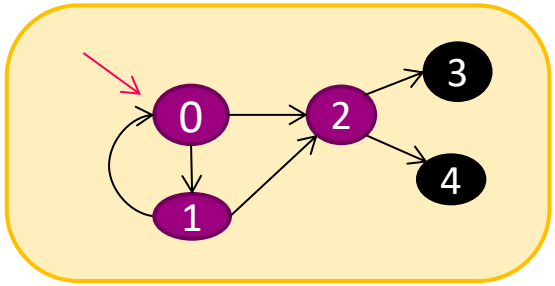
- O&A usually define "coverage" with respect to a "**TR**" = a **set** of *test requirements.*
- For example:

  TR = { "cover line k" | k is a line in P's source }

  Or simply: TR = { k | k is a line in P's source }, and implicitly we mean to "cover" every k.

- Def. 1.21/2nd Ed 5.24. *A coverage criterion = a TR to fulfill/cover.*

CFG-based TR



- A path can be used to express a test-requirement. For example we can specify as our TR:

$$TR = \{ [0,2], [1,2], [3] , [4] \}$$

- But what does “covering” a path e.g. [0,2] mean? (there are several plausible definitions btw)

Paths as test requirements

- Some plausible definitions of "test path *p* covers a required path *q*" :
  1. all nodes in *q* appear in *p.*
  2. *q* is a **subpath** of p (*p* can be written as *prefix* ++ *q* ++ *suffix*, for some *prefix* and *suffix.*
  3. *q* is a **subsequence** of *p* (there is a way to delete some elements from *p* to obtain *q)*.
- Example:
  - [1,2] is a subpath of [0,1,2,3]
  - [2,4] and [1,3] are <u>not</u> a subpath of [0,1,2,3]
  - [1,3] is a subsequence of [0,1,2,3]
- OA use the term "*p* ***tours*** *q*" = *q* is a *subpath* of *p = OA's default definition of "covering q".*

Some basic graph coverage criteria

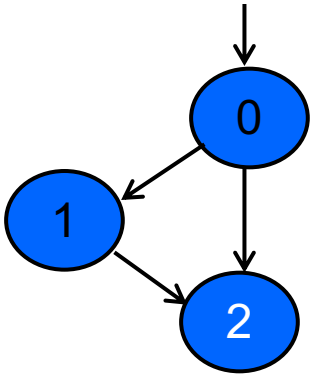
- (C2.1/2nd Ed. C7.7) **Node coverage**: the *TR* is the set of paths of length 0 in G.

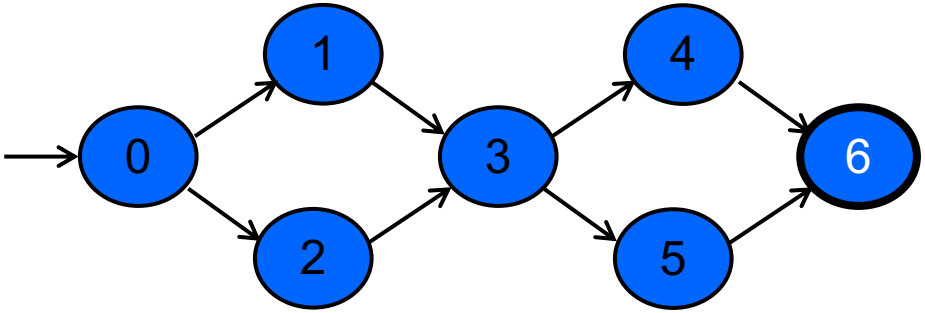
- (C2.2/2nd Ed. C7.8) *TR* is the set of paths of length at most 1 in G.
  - So, what does this criterion tell?
  - Why “at most” ?

- (C2.3/2nd Ed. C7.9) **Edge-pair coverage**: the TR contains all paths of length at most 2.

Examples

- Consider these examples:





- What do we have to cover in C2.1, C2.2, and C2.3?
- What would be the minimal test set for each?

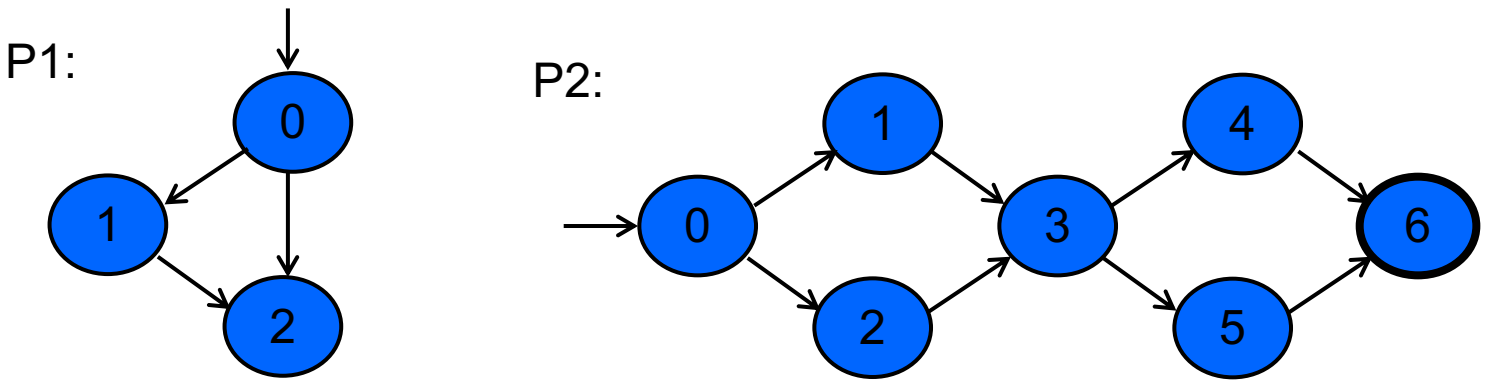
	#tests needed to cover the targets
7 nodes	at least 2
8 edges	at least 2
6 edge-pairs	4
4 paths	4

Subsumption

Def 1.24/2nd Ed. 5.29:

A coverage criterion *C1* <u>*subsumes*</u> (stronger than) *C2* iff every test-set that satisfies *C1* also satisfies *C2*.

Examples subsumption

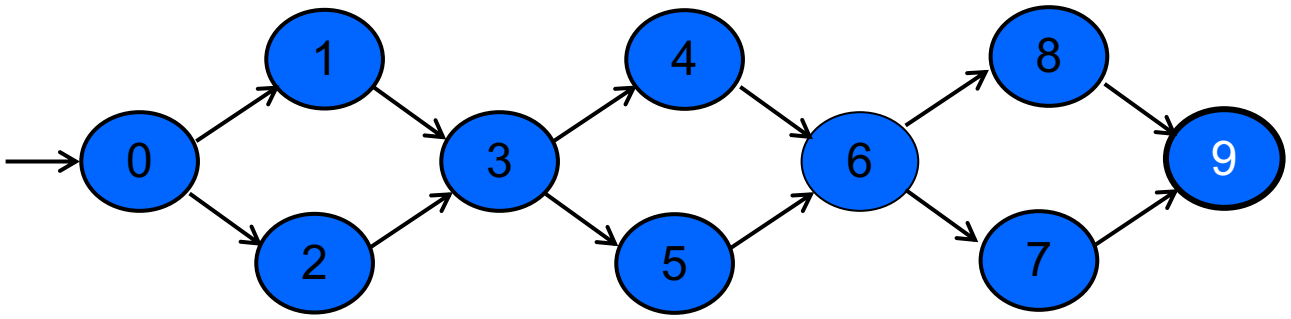


- C2.2 subsumes 2.1 (but not the other way around, demonstrated by P1).
- C2.3 subsumes C2.2 (but not the other way around, demonstrated by P2).

Few notes on TR and subsumption

- Consider a TR has N elements, and assume all are feasible:
  - There exists a test set with at most N elements that fully cover this TR.
  - There may be a test set with less that N elements that fully cover the TR.
- Consider two coverage criteria C1 and C2 and C1 does **not** subsume C2.
  - There exists a program P and a test set for P fulfilling C1 but not C2.
  - But keep in mind that there may be a program Q, where any test set for Q that fulfills C1 would also fulfill C2

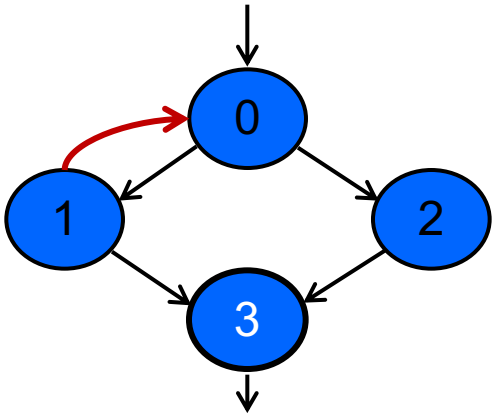
What if we insist on covering ALL paths?



- Path coverage (to cover all paths in the CFG) in the **strongest** graph-based coverage. On the other hand, it is also challenging: #paths in a CFG may explode.
- If the CFG contains a cycle, #paths becomes unbounded.

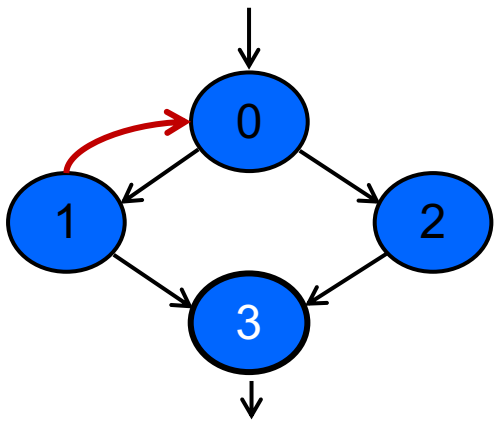
	#tests needed to cover the targets
10 nodes	at least 2
12 edges	at least 2
14 edge-pairs	at least 4
8 paths	8

Prime paths coverage



- A *<u>prime path</u> is a* simple path that is not a subpath of another simple path.
- A *<u>simple path</u> p* is a path where every node in *p* appears only once, except the first and the last which are allowed to be the same.

Example



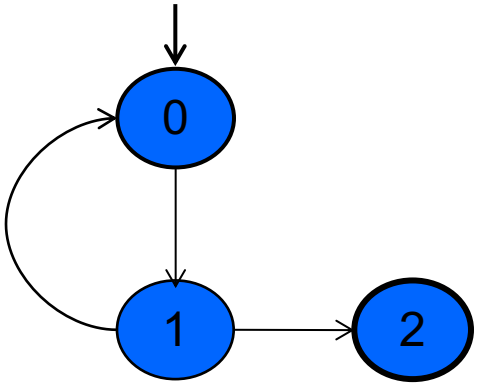
Starting from	prime paths
0	[0,1,0] , [0,1,3]
1	[1,0,1] , [1,0,2,3]
2	-
3	-

Note that [0,2,3] is not a pp (why?).

- (C2.4/2nd Ed. C7.10) PPC: the *TR* is the set of all prime paths in *G*.
- Strong, but still finite.

Few notes on PPC

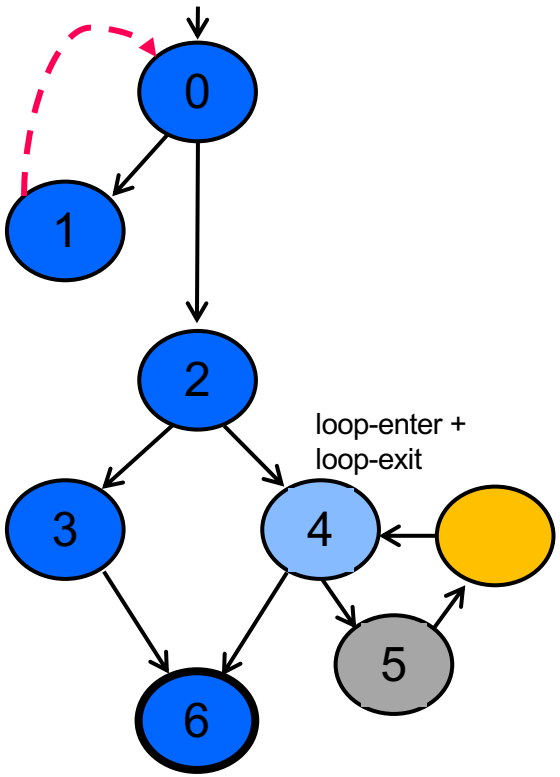
Recall: #TR = N does not mean you also need N tests. Example:



PPC's TR = { 012, 010, 101 }

We can cover this with just one test path: { 01012 }

Identifying Prime Paths



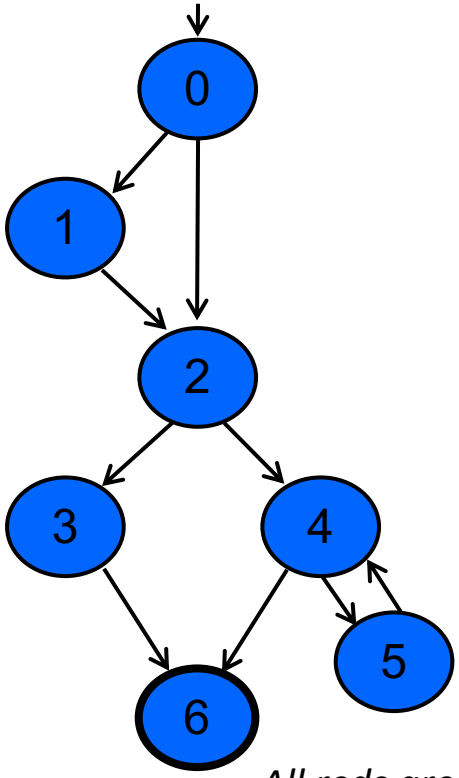
- A cycle with n nodes generate n cyclic pps.
- Not always the case that there is a non-cyclic pp starting from the program entrance.
- A loop may have multiple entry and exit nodes.
- There are non-cyclic pps that end in prev(loop-exit).
- There are non-cyclic pps that start in next(loop-entry).

AO's PPs Algorithm

(to get the set of prime paths)

1. We start with S = set of singleton paths
2. T := subset of S that is right-maximal
   S := S/T
3. while S is not empty:
   1. extend paths in S on the right-side
   2. move those that become right-maximal (cannot be extended to the right and still remain simple paths) to T
   3. Remove members of *T* which are subpaths of other members of *T*.
4. paths in T are prime paths.

Example



S :

[0]
[1]
[2]
[3]
[4]
[5]

T :

[6] x

[0, 1]
[0, 2]
[1, 2]
[2, 3]
[2, 4]
[3, 6] x
[4, 6] x
[4, 5]
[5, 4]

[0, 1, 2]
[0, 2, 3]
[0, 2, 4]
[1, 2, 3]
[1, 2, 4]
[2, 3, 6]
[2, 4, 6]
[2, 4, 5]
[4, 5, 4] *
[5, 4, 6]
[5, 4, 5] *

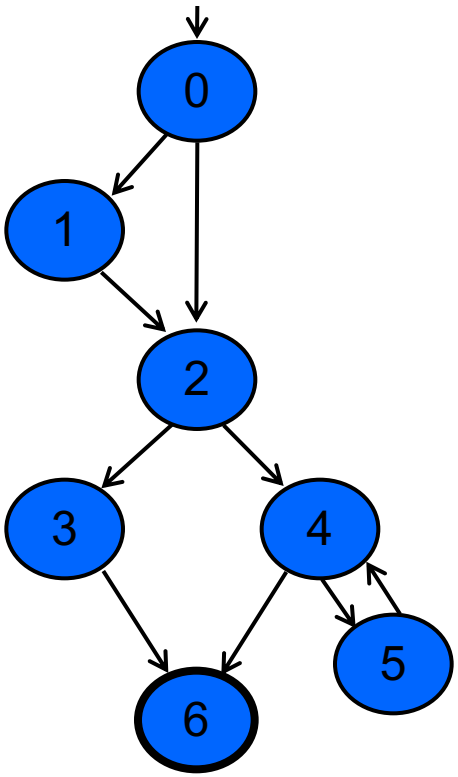
All reds are T, consisting of paths which become right-maximal, and are not a subpath of other members of T.

We also mark :

** → cycle ; definitely a prime path*

x → dropped from T

Example



[0, 1, 2]
[0, 2, 3]
[0, 2, 4]
[1, 2, 3]
[1, 2, 4]
[2, 3, 6] x
[2, 4, 6] x
[2, 4, 5] x
[4, 5, 4] *
[5, 4, 6]
[5, 4, 5] *

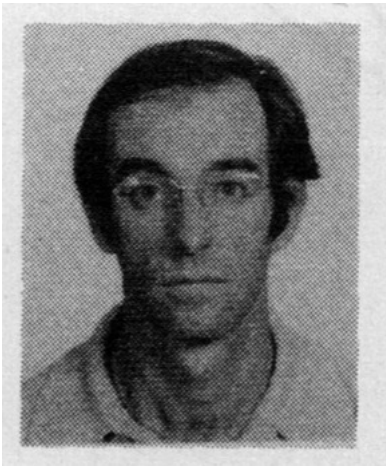
[0, 1, 2, 3]
[0, 1, 2, 4]
[0, 2, 3, 6]
[0, 2, 4, 6]
[0, 2, 4, 5]
[1, 2, 3, 6] x
[1, 2, 4, 5] x
[1, 2, 4, 6] x

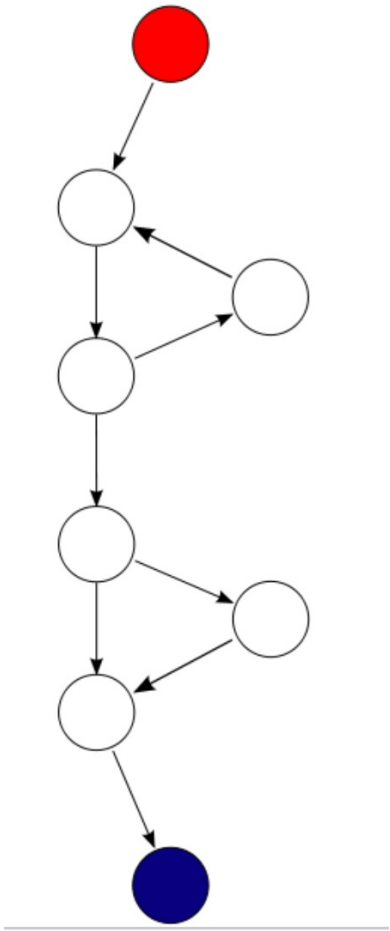
[0, 1, 2, 3, 6]
[0, 1, 2, 4, 6]
[0, 1, 2, 4, 5]

S is now empty; terminate.

What remain in reds/T (those without x) are maximal simple paths = prime paths.

McCabe Complexity of a Program





The ”cyclomatic complexity” of a program is:

$M = E – N + P$

$M = E – N + 2$

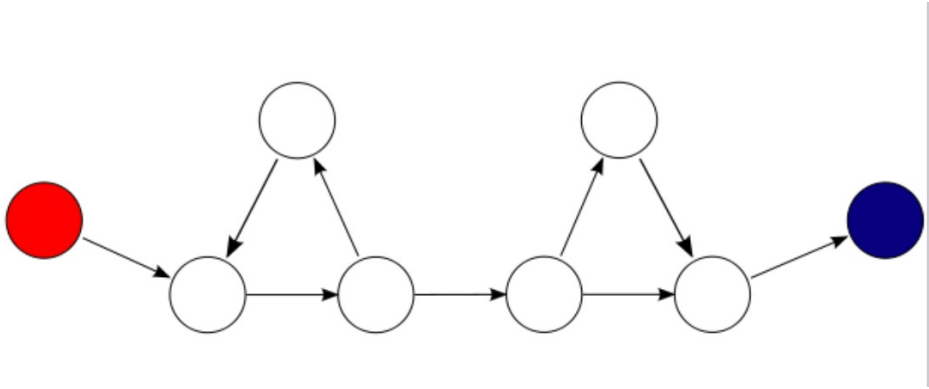
🤔…. but what does this represent??

McCabe's Original Theorem

Definition 1: The cyclomatic number V(G) of a graph G with n vertices, e edges, and p connected components is

$$v(G) = e - n + p.$$

Theorem 1: In a strongly connected graph G, the cyclomatic number is equal to the maximum number of linearly independent circuits.



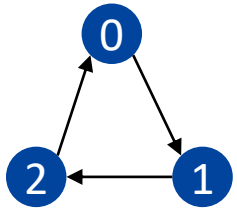
Note that this CFG does not actually form a strongly connected graph

Connection with program complexity and testing

Premise: the circuits (“loops”) are the main source of a program’s complexity. So we should at least test them all.

- Linearly independent circuits “corresponds” to ”elementary” loops you have in the program.
- Question: what happen with a program without loop?

Linearly Independent Circuits



linerarly independent circuits = 1

Note that in a cycle like this #edge = #node

So, #lics = E – N + 1 ?

Circuit: a path that starts and ends in the same node, and never repeats an edge.

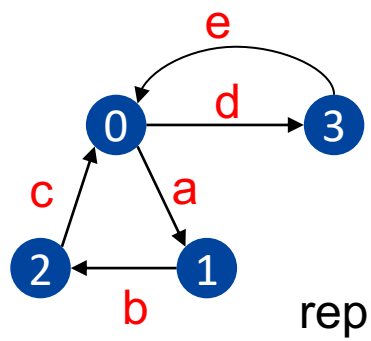
In the above example we have 3 circuits: [0,1,2,0], [1,2,0,1], and [2,0,1,2]

A set C of circuits are linearly independent from each other if evert circuit in C cannot be expressed as a “linear sum” of other circuits in C.

An obvious case: if each circuit in C has an edge that others do not have, the circuits in C **are linearly independent.**

linearly (in)dependent circuits

naming the edges:



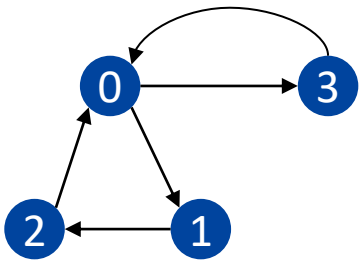
representing vector

circuit	a	b	c	d	e
c_1 = [0,3,0]	0	0	0	1	1
c_2 = [2,1,0,2]	1	1	1	0	0
c_3 = [0,3,0,1,2,0]	1	1	1	1	1

A path in the graph can be represented as a vector over edges, as shown in the examples in the tables above.

- The vector c_3 can be expressed as the linear sum $\alpha c_1+\beta c_2$, with $\alpha,\beta=1$. So c_3 is **not** linearly independent from $\{c_1 , c_2\}$.
- However, c_1 and c_2 are linearly independent from each other as c_1 cannot be expressed as a linear sum over c_2. ($c_1 \neq \alpha c_2$, for any α)

Some note: circuit vs cyclic simple path

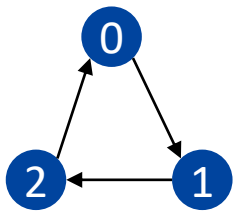


- A circuit does not pass the same edge twice.
- A simple path does not pass the same node twice, except the start and end node.

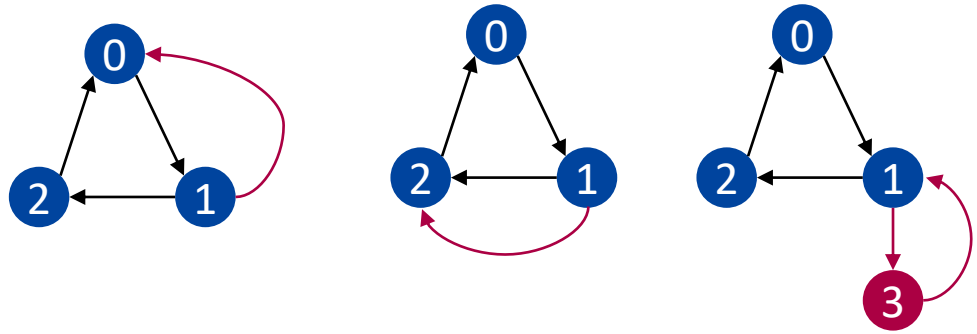
- [0,1,2,0] and [0,3,0] are circuits. They are also (cyclic) simple paths.

- [0,3,0,1,2,0] is also a circuit, **but** not a simple path.

Counting Linearly Independent Circuits

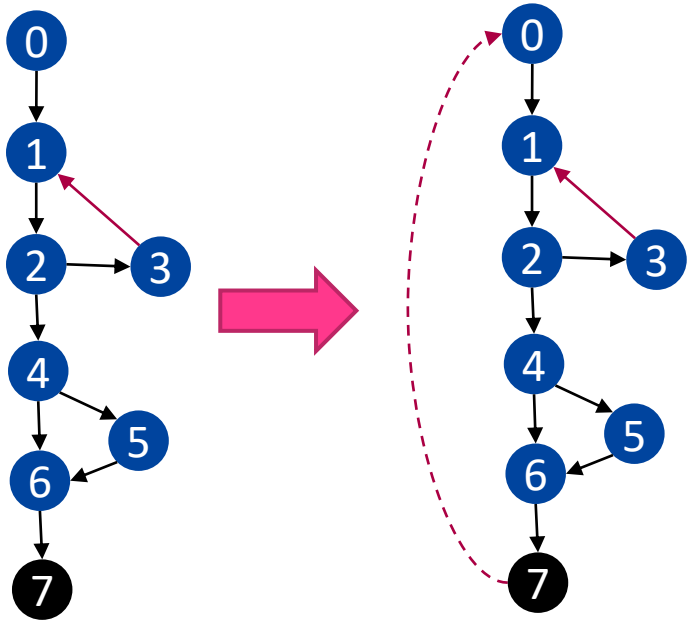


linerarly independent circuits = 1



- Adding new nodes/edges, but we add more edges than nodes → this introduces new cycles.
- In the above examples: we add one more cycle
- **max** number of linearly independent circuits is now 2

Example



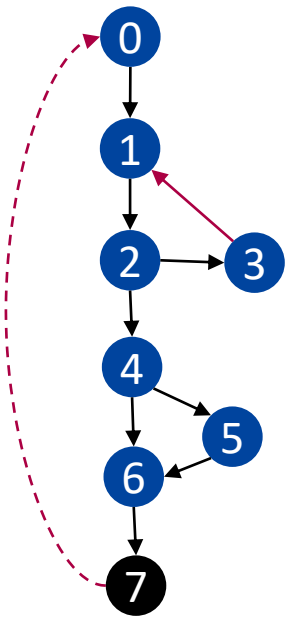
- # linerarly independent circuits = 3
- Can you give them?
- #lics = E – N + 1 (McCabe theorem)
- E = number of edges in the extended CFG = original E + 1

- So, #lics = $E_{original}$ – N + 2

Original CFG is not a strongly connected component.

- To be able to target the non cyclic path e.g. [0,1,2,4,6,7] as a source of that we also want to test, we add a fake edge from exit 7 back to entry node 0 (and also making the CFG strongly connected, so we can use McCabe theorem on it)
- This allows non-cyclic logics to be represented as circuits. E.g. the non-cyclic path [1,2,4,6,7] in the original program is represented as a circuit [1,2,4,6,7,1] in the modified CFG.
- Circuits in the new CFG: [1,2,3,1] , [0,1,2,4,6,7,0], [0,1,2,4,5,6,7,0]. These are also linearly independent from each other.

Relation with test coverage



Premise: the circuits are the main source of complexity in your program.

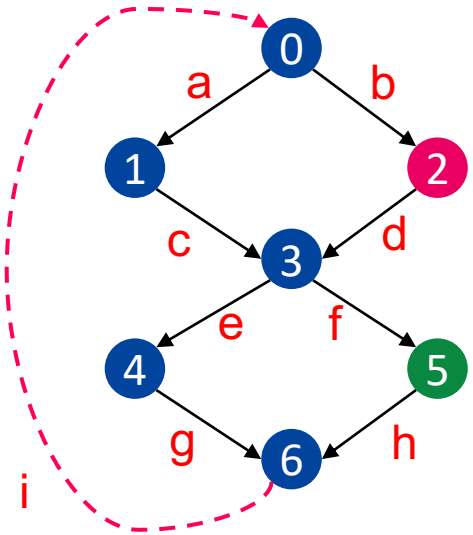
So: aim to cover at least all independent "circuits" in your program:

- [0,1,2,4,6,7,~~0~~] , [0,1,2,4,5,6,7,~~0~~], [1,2,3,1]
- You can remove the fake edge from the TR.

Observations:

- The paths in McCabe TR are linearly independent, so each has something unique.
- McCabe number is not the same as #paths in the program. The later can be exponential or unbounded. #McCabe TR grows much slower.

max. linearly independent set of circuits



N=7, E=8 in the original graph

vector representation

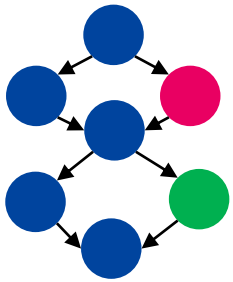
circuit	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	i
c_1 = acegi	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1
c_2 = bdegi	0	1	0	1	1	0	1	0	1
c_3 = acfhi	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	1	1
c_4 = bdfh	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	1

Notice that $c_4 = c_2+c_3 - c_1$, so $\{c_1,c_2,c_3,c_4\}$ does **not** form a set circuits that are linearly independent from each other.

- $\{c_1,c_4\}$ is a linearly independent set, but not maximal in size.
- $\{c_1,c_2,c_3\}$ is also a linearly independent set, and maximal in size.
- Maximal linearly independent set of circuits can be seen as describing “elementary” cycles in your CFG.

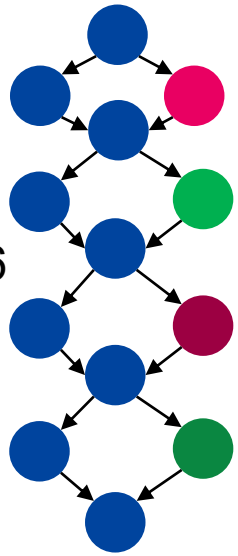
#McCabe-TR growth

N=7, E=8



#McCabe-TR = #independent paths = 3
#tests needed to cover all edges = 2
#tests needed to cover McCabe = 3
#tests needed to cover all paths = 4

N=13, E=16



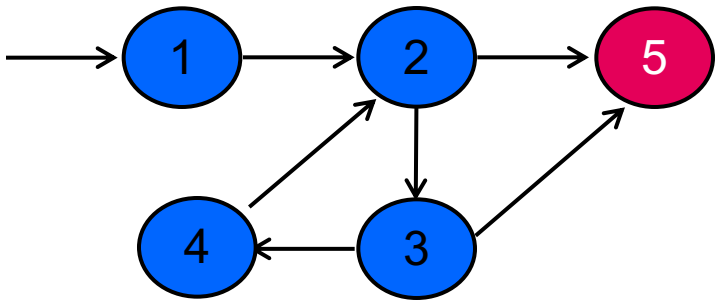
#McCabe-TR = #independent paths = 5
#tests needed to cover all edges = 2
#tests needed to cover McCabe = 5
#tests needed to cover all paths = 16

Unfeasible test requirement

- A test requirement is **unfeasible** if it turns out that there is no real execution that can cover it
- For example, we cannot test a Kelvin thermometer below 0 K.

Typical unfeasibility in loops

```
i = a.length-1 ;
while (i≥0)  {
   if (a[i]==0)  break ;
   i--
}
```



123425 does not tour 125, but with sidetrips it does.

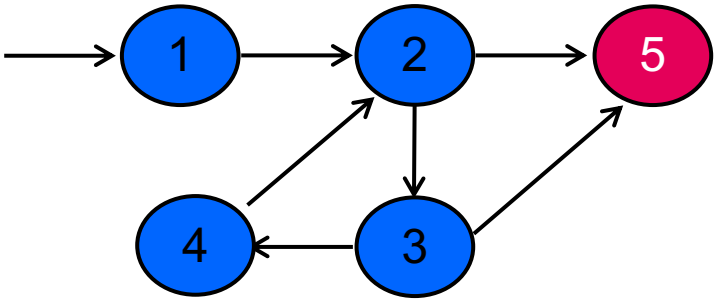
- Some loops <u>*always*</u> iterate at least once. E.g. above if *a* is never empty → prime path 125 is unfeasible.
- (Def 2.37/2nd Ed. 7.36) A test-path *p* tours *q* <u>*with sidetrips*</u> if all *edges* in *q* appear in *p*, and they appear in the same order.

Generalizing Graph-based Coverage Criterion (CC)

- Obviously, sidetrip is weaker that strict touring.
- Every CC we have so far (C2.1, 2.2, 2.3, 2.4, 2.7) can be thought to be parameterized by the used concept of “tour”. We can opt to use a weaker “tour”, suggesting this strategy:
  - First try to meet your CC with the strongest concept of tour.
  - If you still have some paths uncovered which you suspect to be unfeasible, try again with a weaker touring.

Oh, another scenario...

```
i = a.length-1 ;
while (i≥0)  {
   if (a[i]==0)  break ;
   i--
}
```

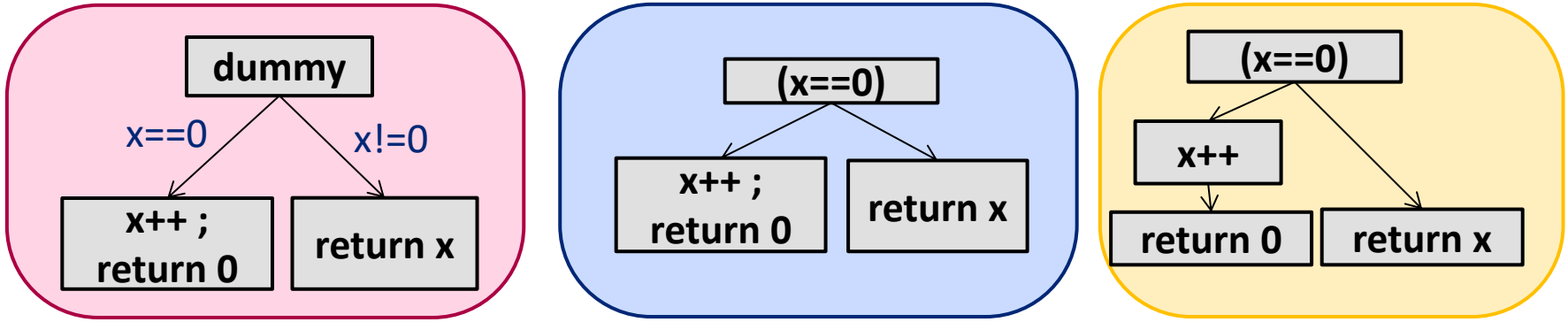


- Often, loops always break in the middle. E.g. above if *a* always contain a 0, then 125 is infeasible.
- Notice: e.g. 1235 does **not** tour 125, not even with sidetrip!
- (Def 2.38/2nd Ed. 7.37) A test-path *p* tours *q* <u>*with detours*</u> if all nodes in *q* appear in *p*, and they appear in the same order (*q* is a subsequence of *p*).
- Weaker than sidetrip.

Mapping your program to its CFG

various ways, depending on the purpose

P1(x) { **if** (x==0) { x++ ; return 0 } **else** return x }

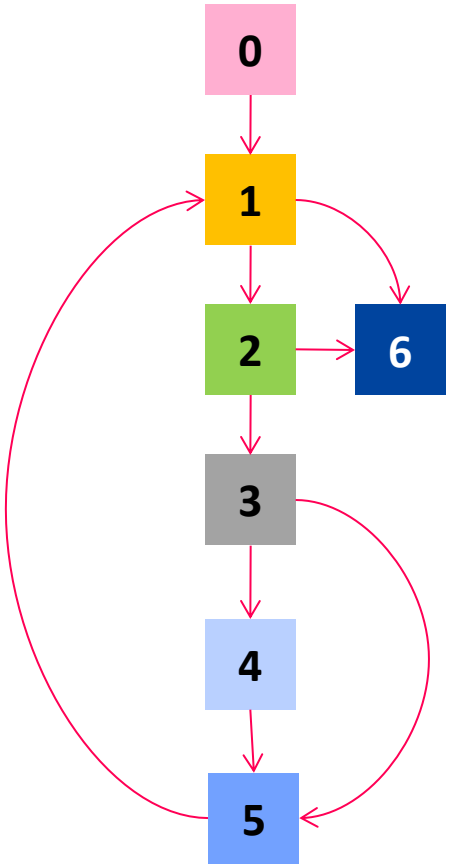


- See Sec. 2.3.1. AO (2nd Ed. 7.3.1) use left; I usually use middle.
- (Sec 2.3.1/2nd Ed. 7.3.1) Define a *block* a maximum sequence of "instructions" so that if one instruction is executed, all the others are always executed as well. Note that this implies:
  - a block does not contain a jump or branching instruction, except if it is the last one
  - no instruction except the first one, can be the target of a jump/branching instruction in the program.

Mapping your program to its CFG

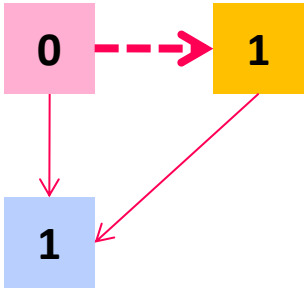
```
P2(a) {
  for (int i=0; i<a.length ; i++) {
    if (a[i]==0) break ;
    if (odd a[i]) continue ;
    b[i] = a[i] ; a[i] = 0
  }
}
```

Add "end-of-program" as a virtual node.



Discussion: exception

```
P3(...) {
   try { File f = openFile("input")
         x = f.readInt()
         y = (Double) 1/x    }
   catch (Exception e) { y = -1 }
  return y
}
```



Every instruction can potentially throw an exception. Yet representing each instruction as its own node in our CFG will increase the size of the graph, and thus also the size of the TR. We can decide to abstract over this, as in the CFG above. But you should be aware of the loss of information. E.g. when a test set manages to cover the exception edge 0→1, we are still unsure if we have tested all sources of this exception.

More discussion

- What to do with dynamic binding ?

```
register(Course c, Student s) {
   if (! c.full()) c.add(s) ;
}
```

You don't know ahead which "add" will be called; it depends on the run-time type of c. E.g. it may refuse to add certain type of students. Graph-based coverage alone is not strong enough to express this aspect.

- What to do with recursion?

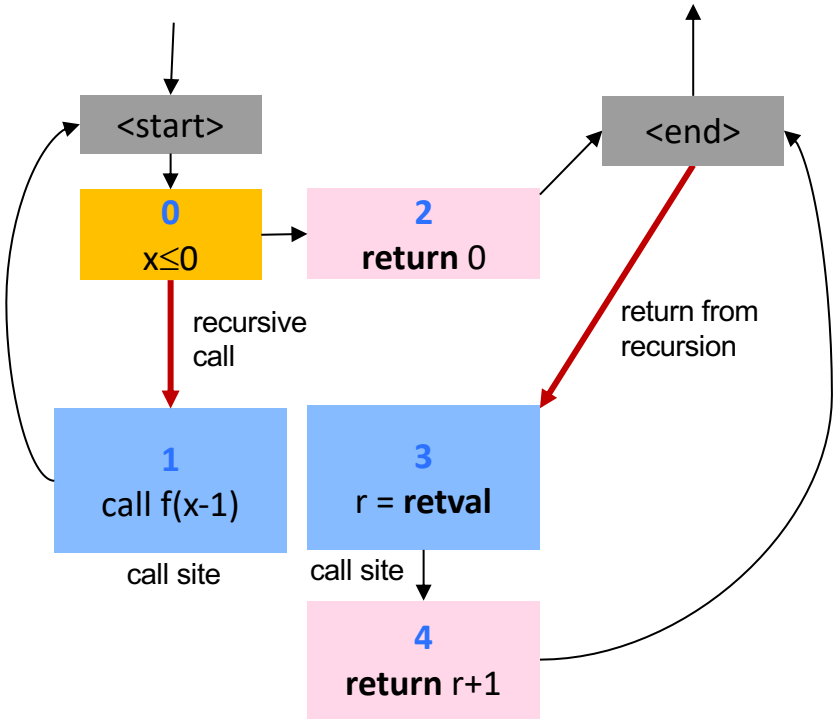
```
f(x) {
  if (x≤0) return 0
  else return f(x-1)
}
```

```
g(x) {
  if (x≤0) return 0
  else { x = g(x-1) ; return x+1 }
}
```

CFG of recursive programs

Constructing the CFG of a recursive program is more complicated. Let's look at two simple examples.

```
f(x) { <start>
  if (x≤0) return 0
  else {
    r = f(x-1)
    return r+1
} <end>
```



*Constrain: **both** red arrows should be taken in equal number of times*